

RepairLink

Comprehensive Market Research & Strategic
Knowledge Base

Prepared by Team Delta • Spark Fellowship 2026

1. Executive Summary

RepairLink is an innovative platform bridging the gap between time-strapped urban consumers and skilled local repair artisans. This document serves as the ultimate knowledge base for RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) architectures, encapsulating the entire strategic vision, market validation, and operational blueprints of the RepairLink initiative.

Our core mission is to disrupt the entrenched "buy-and-discard" culture by making "repair-and-reuse" the default, frictionless choice. By integrating localized trust mechanisms, transparent pricing, and seamless doorstep logistics, RepairLink formalizes the artisan economy.

Reference File Notation: Throughout our operations and marketing archives, you may find related visual assets such as "WhatsApp Image 2026-07-13 at 21.53.04.jpeg" which serves as a visual anchor for our artisan profile concepts. Additionally, raw analytical data can be cross-referenced with "Services app (Responses) (1).xlsx".

2. The Problem Space & Target Persona

2.1 The Buy-and-Discard Loop

Modern urban consumption is trapped in a cycle dictated by convenience rather than sustainability. When an item breaks, consumers face multiple friction points that make replacement easier than repair.

2.2 The "Rahul" Persona

To understand the market, we profile "Rahul," a 22-year-old startup professional living in South/East Delhi. Rahul represents our core demographic: time-poor, digitally native, and sustainability-conscious, yet constrained by reality.

- **The Scenario:** Rahul's favorite office shoes develop worn-out soles. He wants to keep them.
- **The Discovery Gap:** He has no idea where to find a trustworthy cobbler and gets vague answers when asking around.
- **The Convenience Barrier:** The nearest known cobbler is a 15-minute walk away. Between work and commuting, he lacks the time to drop them off and pick them up.

- **The Trust Deficit:** Even if he finds a cobbler, he faces a lack of reviews, no before/after verification, and no accountability on pricing.

The Default Outcome: Rahul abandons the repair effort and buys new shoes for ₹2,500. The old shoes are discarded. The cycle repeats.

3. Market Validation & Catalysts

3.1 The Three Market Catalysts

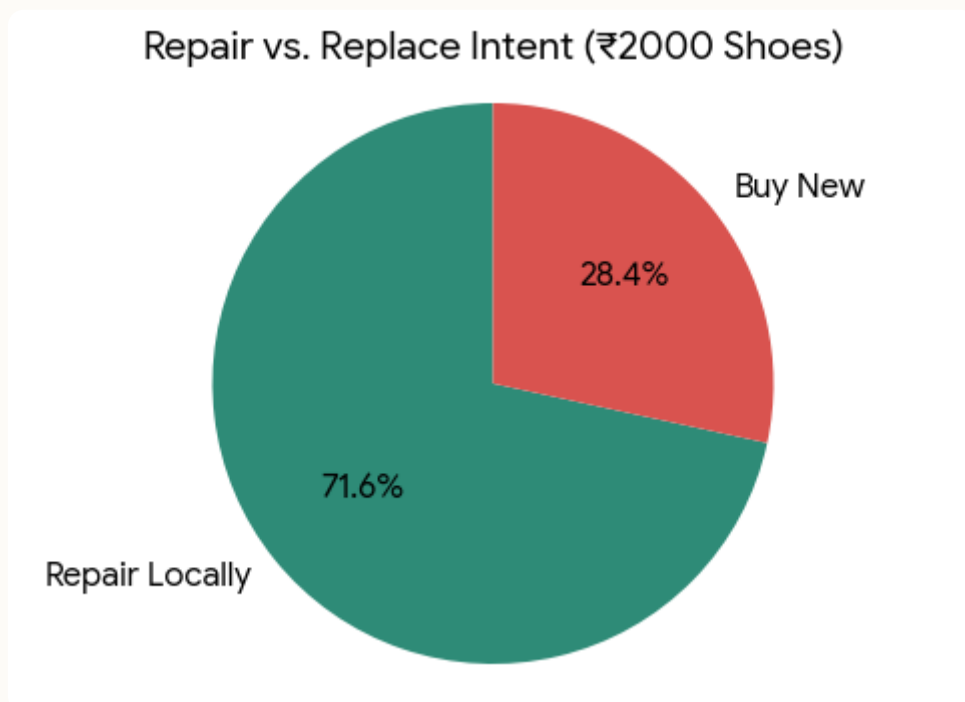
The window of opportunity for RepairLink is actively expanding due to three macroeconomic and cultural tailwinds:

- **Right to Repair Movement (Est. 2022):** The government's push for consumer protection and device repairability creates a cultural shift toward repair over replacement. While currently focused on electronics and appliances, it legitimizes the broader repair economy.
- **The Urban Company Precedent (2014-2024):** Platforms have validated the managed-local-service model. Consumers are conditioned to pay for doorstep professional services, yet the artisan repair category (shoes, bags, garments) remains a massive white space.
- **Sustainability Pressures (2016-2025):** Escalating ESG reporting pressures on brands and stricter e-waste management rules are making repair a critical corporate metric.

3.2 Quantitative Validation (The 3 Frictions)

Based on our comprehensive survey of 116 Delhi-NCR residents, the data overwhelming confirms the existence of the three core frictions:

- **7.8% Discovery Gap:** Only a minute fraction of users always know where to find a reliable artisan.
- **75.9% Convenience Barrier:** Doorstep pick-and-drop is the single highest-rated feature demanded by consumers.
- **42.2% Trust Deficit:** Consumers rely almost exclusively on word-of-mouth because formal trust infrastructure does not exist in this sector.



4. Customer Research & Segmentation

4.1 Demographics

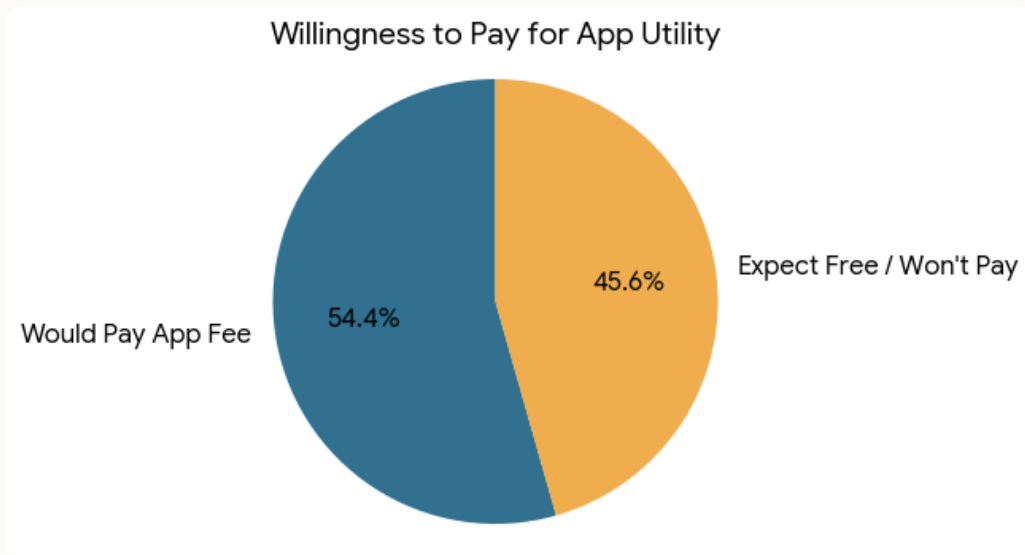
Our primary target audience is the 18-27 urban demographic. This group constitutes 81% of our survey base (18-24 years old), heavily skewing toward students (70.7%) and early-career professionals.

Financially, these households fall into the ₹50,000 to ₹1.5L monthly income bracket. They possess enough discretionary income to afford convenience fees but remain value-conscious enough to avoid unnecessary replacements.

4.2 Segmentation Analysis

We identified two distinct psychographic segments:

- **Convenience-First (Primary Target):** Located predominantly in South and East Delhi, this segment prioritizes time and a seamless UX. They are skeptical of unvetted offline services and demand trust signals (photos, reviews, guarantees).
- **Value-Conscious Repeat Repairers (Secondary):** Located more broadly, this segment already engages in repair. Their primary need is pricing transparency rather than discovery.



5. Product & UX Strategy

5.1 The 2-Tap Solution

RepairLink transforms the arduous offline search into a seamless digital transaction. The UX is anchored by four pillars:

1. **Instant Matching:** A location and rating algorithm instantly surfaces the nearest verified artisans, completely solving the discovery gap.
2. **Doorstep Logistics:** In-app scheduling handles pickup and drop-off, neutralizing the convenience barrier.
3. **The Trust Layer:** Mandatory before/after photo verifications and live turnaround badges instill absolute confidence in the transaction.

4. **Gamified Retention:** A "Waste-Point" rewards dashboard tracks the user's carbon footprint reduction, incentivizing repeat sustainable behavior.

5.2 Psychological Pricing Architecture

Pricing is not a flat fee; it scales based on the replacement cost anchor of the item:

- **Shoes & Bags:** Consumer comfort zone is ₹100–₹300.
- **Clothing Alterations:** Consumer comfort zone is ₹100–₹250.
- **Electronics:** Consumer comfort zone expands to ₹1,000–₹3,000 due to the high cost of replacement.

RepairLink monetizes via a transparent convenience fee (e.g., ₹30–₹50 for shoes/bags) added directly on top of the artisan's quote.

6. Strategic Positioning (The 5Cs & 4Ps)

6.1 The 5Cs Framework

- **Company:** A platform mediating trust and logistics between skilled local workers and busy urbanites.
- **Customers:** 18-27 year-olds in Delhi-NCR with high repair intent but low time availability.
- **Collaborators:** Local artisans, delivery partners (e.g., Dunzo, Porter), and future B2B ESG partners.
- **Competitors:** Zero direct competitors in artisan repair. Indirect competition includes Urban Company (appliances) and the "buy new" retail default.
- **Context:** Regulatory push for right-to-repair combined with an escalating urban time deficit.

6.2 The 4Ps

- **Product:** A bundled flow of discovery, pickup, repair, and return.
- **Price:** Tiered convenience fees based on category ceilings.

- **Place:** Density-first rollout starting in South/East Delhi to ensure rapid logistical fulfillment.
- **Promotion:** Referral-led growth amplified by targeted digital ads highlighting the "Trust Layer" and convenience.

7. Execution Roadmap & Go-To-Market

7.1 Phase 1: MVP & Validation (Months 1-3)

Launch the MVP app (iOS/Android) focusing exclusively on South Delhi. Onboard 50 verified cobblers and bag menders. The goal is 5,000 active users acquired primarily through referral loops, maintaining a strict unit economics margin (e.g., ₹30 fee minus ₹18 logistics cost).

7.2 Phase 2: Scale & Series A (Months 4-6)

Expand geographically to East Delhi (200 artisans) and introduce the electronics repair category. Initiate brand partnerships and close Series A funding (₹8-12 Cr) to support paid acquisition channels. Target: 20,000 users.

7.3 Phase 3: Consolidate & Expand (Months 7-12)

City-wide rollout in Central Delhi (500+ artisans). Launch B2B portals for corporate e-waste and sustainability partnerships. Target: 50,000+ users and approaching operational break-even.

8. Support & Operational Knowledge Base

8.1 Customer FAQ

Q: What devices do you repair?

A: We repair all major electronics including smartphones, laptops, tablets, and smart home appliances, in addition to our core artisan categories (shoes, bags, clothing).

Q: How long does a typical repair take?

A: Most smartphone screen and battery replacements take under 2 hours. Laptops and complex repairs usually take 1-3 business days. Artisan repairs depend on the specific job but are typically completed within 24-48 hours.

Q: Do you offer a warranty on repairs?

A: Yes, we provide a 90-day warranty on all parts and labor for every repair completed through RepairLink.

8.2 Partner Onboarding

Q: How can I become a RepairLink certified technician?

A: You can apply through our Partner Portal. We require a minimum of 2 years of verifiable experience and passing our standard assessment test.

Operational Mandate: All technicians are background-checked and parts are sourced from verified OEMs where possible to uphold our rigorous Trust Layer.

9. Risk Assessment (SWOT)

Strengths: Technical expertise, behavioral marketing knowledge, and a complete lack of direct competitors in the artisan niche.

Weaknesses: Current lack of an established artisan network (0% onboarded today) and the inherent complexity of mastering hyperlocal logistics.

Opportunities: Leveraging ESG corporate mandates and expanding to Tier 1 cities (Bangalore, Mumbai) in Years 2-3.

Threats: Urban Company pivoting into the artisan category, supply-side resistance from traditional artisans, and logistical economics degrading at scale.

10. Conclusion

RepairLink is uniquely positioned to formalize a massive, highly fragmented market. By systematically dismantling the discovery gap, the convenience barrier, and the trust deficit, we are not just building a service marketplace—we are fundamentally re-wiring urban consumer behavior toward sustainability.